



Light pollution getting worse

According to a study published last week in Science Advances, the world is getting brighter. <http://digit.in/LightPol>



Aquaman vs 7 Marvel movies

After Justice League in Nov, there are seven Marvel movies before Aquaman next year. <http://digit.in/MarvelvsDC>

GEEK-KEY

based in California, US, conducted a survey amongst 1,381 respondents, in which a majority were children, under the age of 18. They aimed to find



Credit: HBO

To no one's surprise, GOT Merchandise practically flies off shelves

“whether archers in popular film and television programs inspired people to take up the sport”. The survey found that a sizable portion of young girls were inspired by Princess Merida and Katniss Everdeen (characters from the movies *Brave* and *The Hunger Games* respectively) to take up archery. Both movies were released in 2012. On the other hands, boys

said they were inspired by characters such as Legolas from *Lord of the Rings* and the *Green Arrow*. You can read the whole report at: <http://digit.in/KatnissLove>

While people taking up archery was a positive impact that popular culture had, there are times when it's blamed for some evils. The series *Breaking Bad* was one of this decade's most critically acclaimed shows. It's basically about a struggling high school chemistry teacher who is diagnosed with terminal lung cancer. In order to provide for his family financially after his death, he starts synthesizing crystal meth and selling it with the help of a former student who is a drug dealer. The show quickly became very popular across the globe. At the peak of the show's popularity, Europe saw an alarming rise in the usage of Crystal Meth. Britain in particular, had a 400% rise in people attempting to smuggle in the drug. Even more worrisome, Germany saw a whopping increase of 61% in usage. While this rampant increase in usage of the drug couldn't be definitely ascertained to *Breaking Bad*, it's not a huge leap of imagination to at least assume that the two are somewhat correlated. Read more

about this disturbing trend at <http://digit.in/BadMeth>

An interesting thing to note is that trends begin when a character in popular media is either relatable to us or easily serves as a role model. More specifically, a role model with easily visible flaws and weaknesses. Young girls were able to relate with Princess Merida from *Brave* when they had trouble with their parents. Geeks could relate with the idiosyncrasies that Sheldon Cooper from *The Big Bang Theory* possessed. Misunderstood teenagers could relate with Jessie from



Breaking bad indeed...

Breaking Bad, etc. People wanted to be as strong as Katniss Everdeen, even though she had obvious priority flaws. then of course there's Iron Man, who everyone wants to be.

What attracts us to a character is wanting to emulate him or her. From picking up a skill to wearing the same kind of clothes and eating the same kind of food, a trend develops. Whether this is a good or a bad thing, we'll let the emulators decide. But the fact remains that popular reel has far flung effects on the real world. So what do you think? Is there any product you have purchased just because a character uses it? Write to us at editor@digit.in and tell us all about it.

And don't fool yourself into believing that this is a recent phenomenon – Popeye increased spinach sales by 33% in the States. And that to in the 1930s, which was during the Great Depression! (<http://digit.in/spiNOch>) Now we can't help but wonder if Chota Bheem had a similar effect on Ladoo sales in India.... :-)



The Hunger Games movie

No this photo is here for a different purpose other than just getting a Jlaw picture in